



“DEVELOPING SMALLER CITIES TO STOP MIGRATION”

Telangana minister D. Sridhar Babu on how the government is building a ‘net-zero’ emissions city to foster sustainable living. **BY SIDDHARTH ZARABI**

D. SRIDHAR BABU, Minister for Information Technology, Electronics & Communications, Industries & Commerce and Legislative Affairs, Telangana talks about the state’s plans for developing Tier II and Tier III cities. Edited excerpts:



On infrastructure expansion in Telangana.

Our government is focussed on a sustainable development model. With growing population in urban areas, it is our responsibility to create a sustainable environment for people to live in. There are two important projects we are taking up to this end—the regeneration of the Musi River in Hyderabad. The river flows about 55 kilometres through our city. And the second is to build a ‘net-zero’ emissions city, where we would put our strength to construct a sustainable model that will be a great example for tomorrow’s world.



On building other industrial hubs across the state besides Hyderabad

After we formed this government, we thought it’s our duty to develop Tier II, Tier III towns and rural areas. We try to stress upon all companies to set up in Tier II and Tier III cities where we have talent just like in Hyderabad. We are building strong infrastructure in these areas including require-



ments like optic fibre network till the last mile.

This is the reason the CM has thought of classifying the state into three zones. One is from the main core city to outer ring road, from the outer ring road to regional ring road, and from the regional ring road to connect all the rural areas, all districts. There would be rural areas with agri-processing zones, where rural employment will get an impetus. From the outer ring road to the regional ring road, we will have industries which cause lesser pollution, and then from there to the city, zero pollution industries.

This is our plan of action to stop migration of people from rural areas to urban zones, as otherwise the resources will become scarce. **BT**

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